E1iz@b3ths_D1g1t@_N0t3b00k_1 - Digital_History_in_the_Wild

Theory!

This week, we orient ourselves towards considerations of power and access in digital humanities and in the greater digital realm - questions of agency are around every corner.

To pursue a digital practice in a good way is to consider how the choices you make impact both users and those whose lives intersect with your research, even (or even most especially) when those choices seem normative/intuitive in your work. A few points of departure got us thinking about the nuances of doing digital work ethically and expertly:

1. Categorization

- D'Ignazio and Klein
  - We need categorization to build infrastructure, but the categories we choose have consequences. Can be used to *dehumanize/humanize, erase/expose*, *maintain*/*unsettle*, *stigmatize*/*contexualize*, *heal/harm*
    - being represented can be healing and connective when communities have a lot of agency in the process
    - representation can also mean exposure to harm by policy-makers, structures of violence, bad-actors
  - User-facing platforms have us categorize ourselves, but often they control the method/terms of categorization. And behind the scenes, may be categorizing us in a totally diff way without our consent
  - Must question: is categorization even helpful here? What kind of categorization? Who decides? WHO counts?
  - Powerful when people in communities can decide how they categorize themselves
    - knowledge-keepers, elders
    - marginalized people

2. Care (Qs of Responsibility and Agency)
   -> Being made visible/ being a research subject can lead to harm by researchers and by bad actors seeking to misuse data to stigmatize/marginalize

- D'Ignazio and Klein
  - Data isn't neutral and nor are the conclusions we come to about it
  - Data is not objective (ex. GDELT)... need to look at how collected, by who, and for what purpose

    - The numbers can't speak for themselves when our world is embedded in structural violence... data has been cooked by context
- Gupta, Martindale, Supernant, and Elvidge
    - Practice of CARE about being in relation with people
    - Data practices should benefit Indigenous peoples long-term, about building workforce/sovereignty/governance power
    - Indig people should own the data about them "nothing about us without us" and should be able to access about themselves
    - On EVERYONE to uphold CARE, not just Indigenous peoples
      -> Before *we* use something, we should consider the conditions in which it was produced and circulated
    - by who? which methods appropriate for processing and transformation? where compiled? how misuse minimized?
- CARE principles (Collective benefit, Authority to Control, Responsibility, Ethics)
    - Should support projects that support Indig use of data for enriching/strengthening communities and nations
    - Should follow Indigenous protocols and structures
    - Right to informed, real consent in collection/use/policy
    - Should be reciprocal and maximize benefit now and in future
    - NOT EVERYONE SHOULD BE ABLE TO ACCESS DATA THAT IS ABOUT RELATIONAL ACCESS
      -> consider the ways in which your own life could be datafied: collect, clean, analyze, distribute.

2. Methodological rigor

- Metadata is methodological rigour
    - "zombie data" (D'Ignazio and Klein) when data does not have providence and is unusable/inaccessible to its potential audience
    - should contextualize how you are using terms to avoid misinterpretation by both bad and well-meaning actors
    - should provide direction on what kinds of questions are appropriate to ask of the data
    - Knowledge is situated; make this situation visible
    - data guides for data sets
    - "until we invest as much in providing (and maintaining) context as we do in publishing data, we will end up with public information resources that are subpar at best and dangerous at worst" - D'Ignazio and Klein
- FAIR (Findability, Accessibility, Interoperability and Reusability)
    - Not sufficient without CARE (my opinion)

- globally unqiue, persistent identifiers resolvable by machines
- rich, unambiguous metadata so discoverable and understandable if it disappears
- searchable/registered
- protocol of accessing is clear, clear license
- can implement Authentication and Authorization Infrastructure
- qualified references

4. Stuff that goes wrong

- the "gotchas" are just as, if not more, informative than anything else. This is where we learn about the process
- this is also where we learn about the nature of information online: things that are not constantly updated & reproduced can die
  - stresses the importance of reproducibility and access
  - why we cant do it alone!
- stresses the importance of metadata; it captures what something meant even after the data is gone
- helps us avoid being assholes; let's not be show-off tech bros.. Let's show what we got wrong and help eachother grow

Methodology!

1. Research Data Management

- Must consider end product to even approach methodology/process
- Research Data Management on Carleton's library website
  - categorizes by sensitive data (may bring harm, may require anonymizing), Indigenous data (partner not subjcts), qualitative data, and quantitative
- Best practices for documenting data
  - folder organization / directory structure
    - folder structure generator tool https://alpozturkcarleton.github.io/AlpTools/folder-structure-generatorv4.html
      - shows you exactly whats happening in command as you do it
      - file name template building metadata into file name itself
- README to contain metadata, permissions/license all in one spot

GOOGLE COLAB

Play button runs the cell, shift + enter runs a string
CELL = container of data

STRING = the sequence, line of code

To make something appear:

print( )

To comment

- Pound key (#) starts a comment
- For multi-line comments, use three ''' marks at beginning and end of comment
- or create a new cell and format it like markdown text

order of running cells

- order in which runs cell matters... once you define a variable and run it, it stays in the notebook memory for other cells while the runtime i active
- in colab number in [] next to cell shows when executed

Some useful python language

pip can download, install, and manage external libraries that are not part of Python.

! talks to your system instead of python

ex. !pip install

"Title": full_page_data.title = "title" is the container part
and the code is the data part... telling machine what to go get

import pandas as pd loads pandas library into environment and gives nickname pd

pandas is an open source library

Other Terminology

- data: the information/thing itself
- metadata: the context
- paradata: our discussion/thinking about it all
- Matrix of domination: how categories intersect to enhance opportunities for some people and constrain opportunities for others
- Big Dick Data: "data projects that are characterized by patriarchial, cis-masculinist, totalizing fantasies of world domination as enacted through data capture and analysis." - D'Ignazio and Klein

I modified the Colab code to make a list of hamster-related wikipedia articles:

0	Hamster	Hamsters are rodents (order Rodentia) belongin...	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hamster
1	Golden hamster	The golden hamster or Syrian hamster (Mesocric...	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Golden_hamster
2	Hamster & Gretel	Hamster & Gretel is an American animated super...	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hamster_%26_Gretel
3	Chinese hamster	The Chinese hamster (Cricetulus griseus or Cri...	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chinese_hamster
4	European hamster	The European hamster (Cricetus cricetus), also...	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/European_hamster
5	Winter white dwarf hamster	The winter white dwarf hamster (Phodopus sungo...	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Winter_white_dwa...
6	The Hamsters	The Hamsters were a British band from Southend...	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Hamsters
7	Campbell's dwarf hamster	Campbell's dwarf hamster (Phodopus campbelli) ...	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Campbell%27s_dwa...